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what is textarea in html



The `<textarea>` tag in HTML is a form element used to create a **multi-line plain-text input** field. It is the standard way to collect large amounts of free-form text from users, such as comments, feedback, or messages.  MDN Web Docs +3

Key Features

- **Multi-line Input:** Unlike a standard `<input type="text">`, which is limited to a single line, a textarea allows users to enter multiple lines of text and use the "Enter" key for line breaks.
- **Paired Tag:** It requires both an opening `<textarea>` and a closing `</textarea>` tag.
- **Default Text:** Any text placed between the opening and closing tags will appear as the initial or default value in the field.
- **Plain Text Only:** It treats all content as plain text, meaning any HTML tags inside will be displayed as literal strings rather than rendered as code.  MDN Web Docs +5

Common Attributes

You can control the behavior and size of a textarea using various attributes: 

- `rows` and `cols`: Defines the visible height (number of lines) and width (average character width) of the area.
- `name`: Essential for form submission; it acts as the key for the data sent to the

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submitted. W3Schools +4

Basic Example

html

```
<label for="feedback">Your Comments:</label>
<textarea id="feedback" name="feedback" rows="4" cols="50" placeholder="This is default text that will appear in the box.">
</textarea>
```

Use code with caution.



Styling and Resizing

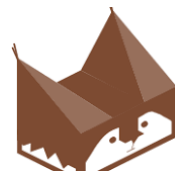
While `rows` and `cols` set the initial size, most modern browsers allow users to manually resize a textarea by clicking and dragging the bottom-right corner. You can disable this or set a specific size using CSS properties like `width`, `height`, and `resize: none;`. React +2



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HTML textarea tag - W3Schools

Definition and Usage. The tag defines a multi-line text input control. The element is often used in a form, to collect ...



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why does it work

The `<textarea>` works because it is a **built-in browser component** specifically designed to handle long-form, multi-line text, which standard single-line inputs cannot handle due to historical and technical constraints. [🔗](#)

1. Browser Rendering

When a browser's rendering engine (like Chrome's Blink or [Safari's WebKit](#)) sees the `<textarea>` tag, it doesn't just draw a box; it creates a complex interactive object. [🔴 YouTube · Simple HTML Studio](#)

- **The Text Editor Engine:** Browsers use a specialized "edit control" internally to manage text wrapping, cursor movement, and line breaks.
- **Dynamic UI:** The browser automatically adds a [scroll bar](#) if the user types more text than the visible `rows` and `cols` allow. [🔴 YouTube · EJ Media +3](#)

2. Historical & Technical Necessity

You might wonder why it isn't just `<input type="textarea">`. There are two main reasons for this: [🔗](#)

- **SGML Limits:** In early versions of HTML (based on SGML), attributes like `value="..."` had character limits (sometimes as low as 240 or 1024 characters). Because people needed to submit thousands of characters,



- **Submission:** When you click "Submit," the browser takes everything between the tags (including line breaks) and pairs it with the `name` attribute as a single string to send to the server.
- **Plain Text Security:** It is programmed to treat everything inside it as **plain text only**. If a user tries to type `<script>alert("hack")</script>` into a textarea, the browser will not execute it; it just sends it as a literal string of characters. YouTube · Leela Web Dev +4

Would you like to know how to **style a textarea with CSS** to make it automatically resize as the user types?



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HTML textarea element - MDN Web Docs - Mozilla

Apr 24, 2026 — Output. ... The above example demonstrates a number of features of : * An id attribute to allow the to be associated wi...



MDN Web Docs



Why does HTML TextArea have its own HTML tag? [closed]

Dec 28, 2011 — * 3 Answers. Sorted by: 10. Because has the rows and cols attributes that are specific to it. If it were a type of , these...



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Why do web developers use the tag over ... - Quora

Jun 27, 2019 — * Mark Bernhardt. Owner at SMBworks, LLC (2019–present) Author has. · 6y. The tag is for short form text entry, like a name or an

